

SELIM ELBADRI

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PLACEMENT INFORMATION

Primary Field	Macroeconomics, Growth & Development, Structural Change
Secondary Fields	Human Capital, Innovation
Expected Completion	March 2027
Placement Officers	Gianni de Fraja, Professor of Economics, gianni.defraja@nottingham.ac.uk Marit Hinnosaar, Associate Professor, marit.hinnosaar@nottingham.ac.uk
Placement Support	Natalia Bas, Senior Operations Officer, natalia.bas@nottingham.ac.uk

EDUCATION

PhD Economics [Candidate] <i>University of Nottingham, UK</i> Thesis title: Essays on Growth & Development Advisors: Markus Eberhardt & Juan I. Vizcaino	2022–2027 (expected)
MRes Economics [Distinction] <i>University of Nottingham, UK</i>	2021–2022
MSc Economics for Development [Merit] <i>University of Oxford, UK</i>	2017–2018
BA (Hons) International Development [First Class] <i>King's College London, UK</i>	2014–2017

JOB MARKET PAPER

Early Childhood Development and Structural Change [\[Paper\]](#)

This paper presents a theory of how early childhood development shapes structural change. I begin by documenting two novel cross-country facts: parental childcare time devoted to young children (ages 0–4) and early childhood human capital outcomes both rise with economic development. These patterns accompany the rising employment share of High-Skill Services with development. I then construct a heterogeneous agents general equilibrium model in which early childhood development raises the productivity of human capital investments in subsequent stages of childhood, increasing the supply of skills and, in turn, driving structural change. The model integrates a multi-stage human capital production function with dynamic complementarity and endogenous labor supply into a standard structural change model with non-homothetic preferences and unbalanced sectoral TFP growth. The model matches patterns of time use, structural change, and the skill distribution in the postwar US, and rationalizes both novel cross-country facts. I show that the rise in parental childcare time devoted to young children accounts for 35% of the US shift toward High-Skill Services in general equilibrium. Early childhood development is therefore a quantitatively important driver of structural change.

WORKING PAPERS

An Anatomy of the Baumol Cost Disease [\[Paper\]](#)

Joint with Juan I. Vizcaino

A Services-Led Growth Escalator?

DATASETS

Measuring US Industry Level Productivity: 1947–2023 [\[Github Repo\]](#) [\[Dataset\]](#)

Joint with Juan I. Vizcaino

POLICY WRITINGS

Fiscal Discipline and Private Finance Mobilization: Can MDBs Help? [[AIIB Working Paper](#)]

Joint with Soumya Bhadury (AIIB Working Paper No. 18)

Water Stress and Sovereign Credit Ratings

Joint with Arrad Tabandeh (forthcoming, AIIB Working Paper)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant for Project: “Occupational Dynasties & Economic Development” 2023–2025

Authors: David Lagakos, Siddharth George, and Martin Shu

Remote

Visiting Researcher (Fall Semester)

2024

Host: Rodolfo Manuelli

Washington University in St. Louis, USA

WORK EXPERIENCE

Summer Intern, Economics Department

2025

Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), China

Summer Intern, Economics Department

2024

Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), China

MENA Country Risk Analyst

2018–2021

Fitch Group, UK

Short-Term Consultant

2018

World Bank Group (WBG), USA

Short-Term Consultant

2018

International Finance Corporation (IFC), Remote

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2023–2024

University of Nottingham, UK

ECON2012: Financial Economics

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2022–2023

University of Nottingham, UK

ECON1050: Introduction to Economics [Macro]

ECON1051: The Politics of Economics and the Economics of Politicians

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

- 2026** Washington University in St. Louis Economics Graduate School Conference (scheduled); Tools for Macroeconomists Research Workshop; International Economic Association (IEA) 21st World Congress; 2nd International Conference of the Georgian Economic Association; 16th Annual Meeting of the Armenian Economic Association
- 2024** Washington University in St. Louis Macro Brown Bag; Ruhr Graduate School (RGS) Doctoral Conference in Economics; Centre for the Study of African Economies (CSAE) Conference; University of Macedonia 8th International Meeting in Economics
- 2023** Nottingham PhD Economics Conference; Centre for the Study of African Economies (CSAE) Conference
- 2022** Nottingham MRes Dissertation Conference; Nottingham Macro Working Group

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

ESRC +3.5 Doctoral Scholarship, University of Nottingham	2022
Top of Class, MRes Economics, University of Nottingham	2022
School of Economics Scholarship, University of Nottingham	2021

CODING AND LANGUAGES

Languages	English, Arabic (Fluent) French, Mandarin (Intermediate)
Software	Stata, MATLAB, LaTeX, Julia (Advanced)

REFERENCES

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